

1. Quoting Luke Curley

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-09T01:03:58+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/9/luke-curley/#atom-everything>

WebRTC is designed to degrade and drop my prompt during poor network conditions. wtf my dude WebRTC aggressively drops audio packets to keep latency low. If you've ever heard distorted audio on a conference call, that's WebRTC baybee. The idea is that conference calls depend on rapid back-and-forth, so pausing to wait for audio is unacceptable. ?but as a user, I would much rather wait an extra 200ms for my slow/expensive prompt to be accurate. After all, I'm paying good money to boil the ocean, and a garbage prompt means a garbage response. It's not like LLMs are particularly responsive anyway. But I'm not allowed to wait . It's impossible to even retransmit a WebRTC audio packet within a browser; we tried at Discord. The implementation is hard-coded for real-time latency or else . ? Luke Curley , OpenAI's WebRTC Problem, in response to How OpenAI delivers low-latency voice AI at scale Tags: webrtc , openai

2. Using Claude Code: The Unreasonable Effectiveness of HTML

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-08T21:00:11+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/8/unreasonable-effectiveness-of-html/#atom-everything>

Using Claude Code: The Unreasonable Effectiveness of HTML Thought-provoking piece by Thariq Shihpar (on the Claude Code team at Anthropic) advocating for HTML over Markdown as an output format to request from Claude. The article is crammed with interesting examples (collected on this site) and prompt suggestions like this one: Help me review this PR by creating an HTML artifact that describes it. I'm not very familiar with the streaming/backpressure logic so focus on that. Render the actual diff with inline margin annotations, color-code findings by severity and whatever else might be needed to convey the concept well. I've been defaulting to asking for most things in Markdown since the GPT-4 days, when the 8,192 token limit meant that Markdown's token-efficiency over HTML was extremely worthwhile. Thariq's piece here has caused me to reconsider that, especially for output. Asking Claude for an explanation in HTML means it can drop in SVG diagrams, interactive widgets, in-page navigation and all sorts of other neat ways of making the information more pleasant to navigate. I wrote about Useful patterns for building HTML tools last December, but that was focused very much on inter...

3. Notes on the xAI/Anthropic data center deal

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-05-07T17:09:28+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/May/7/xai-anthropic/#atom-everything>

There weren't a lot of big new announcements from Anthropic at yesterday's Code w/ Claude event, but the biggest by far was the deal they've struck with SpaceX/xAI to use "all of the capacity of their Colossus data center". As I mentioned in my live blog of the keynote , that's the one with the particularly bad environmental record . The gas turbines installed to power the facility initially ran without Clean Air Act permits or pollution control devices, which they got away with by classifying them as "temporary". Credible reports link it to increases in hospital admissions relating to low air quality. Andy Masley, one of the most prolific voices pushing back against misleading rhetoric about data centers (see The AI water issue is fake and Data center land issues are fake), had this to say about Colossus: I would simply not run my computing out of this specific data center I get that Anthropic are severely compute-constrained, but in a world where the very existence of "AI data centers" is a red-hot political issue (see recent news out of Utah for a fresh example), signing up with this particular data center is a really bad look. There was a lot of initial chatter about how this...

4. HomePod mini feels like magic, but it's just good timing

Source: Jeff Geerling | Published: Fri, 08 May 2026 09:00:00 -0500

Link: <https://www.jeffgeerling.com/blog/2026/homepod-mini-feels-like-magic--but-it-s-just-good->

timing/

Apple introduced the HomePod mini six years ago , in 2020. I'm not one into smart speakers, but the feature that made me take a closer look was their ability to form stereo pairs, without any direct wired connection. I know there are other speaker manufacturers with wireless speakers, but to my knowledge, Apple was just using AirPlay over WiFi... so how does it work? Through the magic of buying two HomePods mini (pictured above), I found out. A video detailing the process is embedded below:

5. AI makes weak engineers less harmful

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Sat, 09 May 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/ai-makes-weak-engineers-less-harmful/>

Like other kinds of puzzle-solving, software engineering ability is strongly heavy-tailed. The strongest engineers produce way more useful output than the average, and the weakest engineers often are actively net-negative: instead of moving projects along, they create problems that their colleagues have to spend time solving. That's why many tech companies try to build a small, ludicrously well-paid team instead of a large team of more average engineers, and why so far this seems to be a winning strategy. Being effective in a large tech company is often about managing this phenomenon: trying to arrange things so that the most competent people land on projects you want to succeed, and the least competent are shunted out of the way ¹ . For instance, if you're technical lead on a project, you more or less have to ensure ² that the most critical pieces are in the hands of people who won't screw them up (whether by directly assigning the work, or by making sure someone can sit on the shoulder of the engineer who you're worried about). Claude Code changed this. Frontier LLMs don't have the taste or the system familiarity of a strong engineer, but they have absolutely raised the floor...

6. Notes on incidents

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Fri, 08 May 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/notes-on-incidents/>

Incidents are boring. Most of what you actually do during an incident is wait: for some other team to investigate, or for a deploy to finish, or for the result of some change to become apparent, or for someone else who's been paged to come online. It's stressful, but there's often just not that much to do. Most incidents resolve on their own. People love to share war stories about incidents where some hero engineer improvised a clever fix that instantly repaired the system. That rarely happens. Well-designed software systems tend to come good by themselves, and many modern systems are at least partly well-designed, by virtue of being built out of really solid pieces. If a server process is crashing or leaking memory, Kubernetes will kill the pod and bring it back up. If a service is overloaded and jammed up, clients will (hopefully) trigger circuit breakers and back off until it can recover. Temporary spikes in expensive operations will often just fill up a queue instead of taking the entire system down. Most incident calls I've been on - well over half - would have come good by themselves in roughly the same time without any human intervention. Most incident-resolving actions mak...

7. Developing more confidence when tracking renames via ReadDirectoryChangesW

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Fri, 08 May 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260508-00/?p=112310>

You can track the file ID. The post Developing more confidence when tracking renames via ReadDirectoryChangesW appeared first on The Old New Thing .

8. Pedometer++ 8.0

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-05T18:12:44Z

Link: <https://david-smith.org/blog/2026/04/29/maps-on-watchos/>

David Smith, "Six Years Perfecting Maps on watchOS": I love going on wilderness adventures. I am rarely happier than when I am far off into the mountains without a soul in sight. As a result, I have spent a lot of time learning how to safely explore and navigate when I'm away from civilization. The most important habit I've found for not getting lost is to be very

regular in checking your location as you go, and the best way I've found to do that is to have a map on my wrist. For more than six years I've been working towards creating the best possible mapping experience on the Apple Watch. With yesterday's launch of Pedometer++ 8, I feel like this design journey has reached a meaningful destination. I would contend that Pedometer++'s watchOS mapping support is the absolute best available on the App Store. So I wanted to walk through the journey it took to get here. I love going on wilderness adventures is how you start a post about an app update. Or at least my type of update to my type of app. I don't have any desire for maps on my watch, but reading this makes me want it anyway. Enthusiasm is contagious. (See also: the Pedometer++ blog, and Stephen Hackett at 512 Pixels.)

9. [Sponsor] WorkOS: Ready to Sell to Enterprise? Your Product Is Ready, Your Auth Infrastructure Isn't.

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-05T02:28:25Z

Link: https://workos.com/?utm_source=daringfireball&utm_medium=newsletter&utm_campaign=q22026

If you're building B2B SaaS, especially AI, you quickly need enterprise features like SSO, SCIM, and audit logs. Your developers shouldn't waste cycles rebuilding that infrastructure. Free them to focus on what sets you apart. WorkOS gives you production-ready APIs for auth and access control that integrate directly into your product. Trusted by over 2,000 companies, including OpenAI, Anthropic, Cursor, and Vercel. Build faster with WorkOS ? ?

10. Chess Peace

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-05-05T02:18:00Z

Link: <https://chesspeace.app/>

Chess Peace ? a new iOS game by Sam Shepherd ? is my kind of logic puzzle. Each puzzle is a board with a few unplaced chess pieces. To solve you need to place all the pieces so that none of them attack each other. There's a timer if you care, but I don't. (And you can hide the clock.) Clever name too: the pieces need to be ... at peace with each other. You can download Chess Peace and try it out free of charge, and it's just a one-time payment of \$7 to unlock everything. Great simple premise, really well implemented. ?

11. Pushing Local Models With Focus And Polish

Source: Armin Ronacher's Thoughts and Writings | Published: 2026-05-08T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://lucumr.pocoo.org/2026/5/8/local-models/>

I really, really want local models to work. I want them to work in the very practical sense that I can open my coding agent, pick a local model, and get something that feels competitive enough that I do not immediately switch back to a hosted API after five minutes. There are a lot of reasons why I want this, but the biggest quite frankly is that we're so early with this stuff, and the thought of locking all the experimentation away from the average developer really upsets me. Frustratingly, right now that is still much harder than it should be but for reasons that have little to do with the complexity of the task or the quality of the models. We have an enormous amount of activity around local inference, which is great. We have good projects, fast kernels, and people are doing great quantization work. A lot of very smart people are making all of this better, and yet the experience for someone trying to make this work with a coding agent is worse than it has any right to be. Putting an API key into Pi and using a hosted model is a very boring operation. You select the provider, paste the key and then you are done thinking about how to get tokens. Doing the same thing locally, even...

12. Calculating curvature

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Fri, 08 May 2026 13:54:18 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/05/08/calculating-curvature/>

Curvature is conceptually simple but usually difficult to calculate. For a level set curve $f(x, y) = c$, such as in the previous couple posts, the equation for curvature is Even when f has a fairly simple expression, the expression for κ can be complicated. If we define then the level set of $f(x, y) = c$ is $[?]$ The post Calculating curvature first appeared on John D. Cook .

13. Hi stranger

Source: iDiallo.com | Published: Fri, 08 May 2026 14:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/blog/hi?src=feed>

I'm at home, sitting on the kitchen table. I just took my boys to school and I'm about to start my work. I'm writing this message directly to you. And you are reading it. Hello! Isn't that funny? I've been trying to write consistently, and it gives the impression that I am this serious person with some serious insights. But no, I'm just writing. Sometimes you respond, you send a nice email, other times it's complete silence. It ends up being like an entry in a journal, for me to stumble upon at a later date and reflect: "Oh yeah, that's what I was thinking that day." My job is a 2 hour drive away, so I rent an office close by. There I can focus and clearly delineate work time from home time. I don't like working when I'm home with my family. So I have some time to talk to you. Last year, I spent some time digging through my server logs to find who is reading me. I wanted to know who you are, and why you are interested in reading me? But I can't get an answer from just reading the logs. Instead what I found is that you and most other people come here via RSS. My rough count shows that there are 10,000 of you, or at least 10,000 unique IP addresses that ping the websites whenever I...

14. Steering Zig Fmt

Source: matklad | Published: 2026-05-08T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://matklad.github.io/2026/05/08/steering-zig-fmt.html>

Two tips on using zig fmt effectively. Read this if you are writing Zig, or if you are implementing a code formatter.

15. Detecting (or not) the use of -l and -c together in Bourne shells

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-05-08T03:32:19Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/unix/BourneShellLoginWithCommand>

Many Bourne shells go slightly beyond the POSIX sh specification to also support a '-l' option that makes the shell act as a 'login shell'. POSIX's omission of -l isn't only because it doesn't really talk about login shells at all, it's also because Unix has a special way of marking login shells that goes back very far in its history. The -l option isn't necessarily what login and sshd and so on use, it's something that you can use if you specifically want to get a login shell in an unusual circumstance. Bourne shells also have a '-c' option that causes the shell to execute the command string rather than be interactive (this is a long standing option that is in POSIX). It may surprise you to hear that most or all Bourne shells that support -l also allow you to use -l and -c together. Basically all Bourne shells interpret this as first executing your .profile and so on, then executing the command string instead of going interactive. One use for this is to non-interactively run a command line in the context of your fully set up shell, with \$PATH and other environment variables ready for use. Now, suppose (not hypothetically) that you have some things in your .profile that you woul...

16. Canvas Breach Disrupts Schools & Colleges Nationwide

Source: Krebs on Security | Published: Fri, 08 May 2026 02:58:46 +0000

Link: <https://krebsonsecurity.com/2026/05/canvas-breach-disrupts-schools-colleges-nationwide/>

An ongoing data extortion attack targeting the widely-used education technology platform Canvas disrupted classes and coursework at school districts and universities across the United States today, after a cybercrime group defaced the service's login page with a ransom demand that threatened to leak data from 275 million students and faculty across nearly 9,000 educational institutions.

17. Weekend at Bernie's

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-05-08T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/05/08/weekend-at-bernies.html>

In the 1989 film, two junior employees turn up at their boss's beach house to find him dead, and spend the rest of the weekend wheeling him around the party with sunglasses on so nobody notices. The other guests keep slapping him on the back and putting drinks in his hand. It

works because nobody looks too closely and because everyone has a strong incentive for Bernie to still be alive. I have spent the last couple of weeks trying to work out how many of the open source packages we all depend on are in roughly that condition: resolving in every install, pulling millions of downloads a week, accepting new issues, with nobody behind the sunglasses. I'm asking now rather than a few years ago because AI-assisted vulnerability discovery is changing how often somebody actually checks for a pulse. This matters most at the point where one of those packages gets a security report. Sometimes nobody responds at all, the embargo expires, and a CVE is published with no fixed version to point at. Sometimes a fix does get written, often by the reporter or a drive-by contributor, and it lands in git or sits in an open PR, but the one account with publish rights on the registry has gone and the p...

18. Premium: AI's Circular Psychosis

Source: Ed Zitron's Where's Your Ed At | Published: Fri, 08 May 2026 14:40:45 GMT

Link: <https://www.wheresyoured.at/premium-ais-circular-psychosis/>

In this week's free newsletter, I explained how bad the circular AI economy is in the simplest-possible terms : Anthropic not have money to pay big cloud bills, because Anthropic company cost lots of money, more money than Anthropic make! So Anthropic only PAY cloud bills if OTHERS

19. Pluralistic: Lee Lai's "Cannon" (08 May 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Fri, 08 May 2026 12:19:36 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/05/08/gung-gung/>

Today's links Lee Lai's "Cannon": A beautiful, subtle, long-lingering tale of duty, sex, and working for a shitty restaurant boss. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Ebay paying to run newspaper classifieds; Chuck Tingle v Sad Puppies; FBI v TOR; Daycare v Goldman Sachs; Scammers re-used covid nose-swabs; "The Adventures of Mary Darling." Upcoming appearances: Guelph, Barcelona, Berlin, Hay-on-Wye, London, NYC, Edinburgh. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Lee Lai's "Cannon" (permalink) Lee Lai's Cannon is an extraordinary graphic novel that turns out a beautifully told, subtle and ambiguous tale about Lucy (Lucy -> "Loose" -> "Loose Cannon" -> "Cannon"), a queer Chinese-Canadian chef at a Montreal restaurant whose messy family, work, personal and sex life are all falling apart in ways that are powerfully engrossing: <https://drawnandquarterly.com/books/cannon/> This is the second outing from Lee Lai, whose debut, Stone Fruit, swept many of the field's awards and won major critical acclaim. When a debut comes out that strong...

20. Flower: an SSG with a Clojure template language

Source: the website of jyn | Published: 2026-05-08T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://jyn.dev/talks/flower/>

(No summary)

21. Wander Console 0.6.0

Source: Susam Pal | Published: 2026-05-08T00:00:00Z

Link: <https://susam.net/code/news/wander/0.6.0.html>

Wander Console 0.6.0 is now available. This is the sixth release of Wander, a small, decentralised, self-hosted web console that lets visitors to your website discover interesting websites and pages recommended by a community of independent website owners. To try it, go to susam.net/wander/ . To learn how it works and how to set it up on your own website, see the project README . The main change in this release is the removal of support for the via referral query parameter, which was added to recommended URLs so that website owners could identify visits coming from a Wander Console in their access logs. The via query parameter was introduced in version 0.4.0 in response to community demand , but it turned out to be a misfeature. Some websites refuse to serve web pages when arbitrary query parameters are added

to URLs. Although it was possible to turn this feature off via configuration, I would rather not keep a dubious feature that may prevent some pages from loading successfully. This feature has now been completely removed. See this excellent article by Chris Morgan to learn more about why adding arbitrary query parameters to URLs is a bad idea. Commit b26d77c has more details a...

22. David Reich ? Why the Bronze Age was an inflection point in human evolution

Source: Dwarkesh Podcast | Published: Fri, 08 May 2026 16:38:22 GMT

Link: <https://www.dwarkesh.com/p/david-reich-2>

"Instead of being quiescent, natural selection is everywhere."

23. The Bold Ones Win

Source: Tedium: The Dull Side of the Internet. | Published: 2026-05-08T00:13:15Z

Link: <https://feed.tedium.co/link/15204/17336568/ted-turner-bold-ceo-bets>

We lost Ted Turner, a patron saint of Tedium, just as an entrepreneur made an audacious Turner-style bet. What can we learn from that?

24. This Week on The Analog Antiquarian

Source: The Digital Antiquarian | Published: Fri, 08 May 2026 16:11:33 +0000

Link: <https://www.filfre.net/2026/05/this-week-on-the-analog-antiquarian/>

Opus 1: The Comedy of Errors In other news, I'm afraid there will be no article next week, as my wife and I do some much-needed springtime home-and-garden work. I'll see you in two weeks with some piping-hot fresh content ? dealing very directly with games this time, I promise.

25. George Orwell's review of Russel's Power: A New Social Analysis

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Fri, 08 May 2026 22:35:10 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/orwell-review-bertrand-russells-power/>

I had previously learned a lot from this book review by George Orwell, which is actually a lot more than a book review. Recently I had cause to look it up again and found it had vanished from the searchable internet. With some sleuthing I have recovered a copy of the review from the internet archive. Orwell's review was first published in The Adelphi in January 1939. The review can also be found in its original (scanned) form, also on the internet archive.

26. Dekonstruktion des Programmcodes des BioNTech/Pfizer SARS-CoV-2 Impfstoffes

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Fri, 25 Dec 2020 20:12:20 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/german-reverse-engineering-source-code-of-the-biontech-pfizer-vaccine/>

Willkommen! In diesem Artikel werden wir einen Blick auf den Programmcode des BioNTech/Pfizer SARS-CoV-2 mRNA Impfstoffes werfen, und zwar Zeichen für Zeichen. Ich möchte Allen danken, die zur Korrektheit und Lesbarkeit dieses Artikels beigetragen haben. Für alle Fehler zeige ich mich trotzdem selbst verantwortlich, und würde von ihnen gern schnellstmöglich hören: Via bert@hubertnet.nl oder @bert_hu_bert Hinweise zur deutschen Übersetzung bitte an f.zahn@mailbox.org oder @zahnstein Nun, diese Worte wirken zunächst etwas verstörend - ein Impfstoff ist eine Flüssigkeit, die in meinen Arm injiziert wird.

27. Reverse Engineering the source code of the BioNTech/Pfizer SARS-CoV-2 Vaccine

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Fri, 25 Dec 2020 20:12:20 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/reverse-engineering-source-code-of-the-biontech-pfizer-vaccine/>

Translations: ???????? / ???? / ?? (Weixin video, Youtube video) / ?? / bahasa Indonesia / ?eský/ Català/ ?eský/ Deutsch / Espa ol / ?????? / ?????? / Fran ais / ???????? / Hrvatski / Italiano / Magyar / Nederlands / ??? / ??? 2 / ?????? / Polskie / ???????? / Portugu es / Rom n? / Slovensky / Sloven ina / Srpski / T rk / ???????????? / Markdown for translating / Fun video by LlamaExplains / Video version by Giff Ransom